

BINATONE MASKFONE

Masks are part of our everyday reality now due to the COVID-19 pandemic. Building on that, Binatone debuted the MaskFone at CES 2021 with a price tag of \$50. It is essentially



a washable, N95 mask with an integrated Bluetooth headset that allows users to speak to people without a mask-muffled voice. The earbuds are

attached to the straps that hook around your ears and come equipped with buttons for playing, pausing and changing the volume on the face of the mask itself. It also has Siri and Amazon integration, so you can control your music with voice commands. The battery is rated at 12 hours.

SONY 360 REALITY AUDIO SPEAKERS

Sony announced two new wireless speakers at CES 2021 with a unique design and 360 Reality Audio support for a more immersive experience – the Sony SRS-RA5000 and the Sony SRS-RA3000. Within the Sony SRS-RA5000, there are three drivers that fire audio upwards to give music a sense of height and work alongside three other front-facing drivers to provide sound in a horizontal plane for width and an internal woofer. The positioning of these speakers is designed to provide a 360-degree



audio experience. Both speakers feature Sound Calibration, according to Sony, which offers “optimal sound performance”. Holding down the Immersive Audio Enhancement button on the RA5000 will trigger a sound calibration adjustment in accordance with the room the speaker is placed in. The speakers are also compatible with Google Assistant-enabled devices and have Chromecast built-in. For connectivity, the speakers have Wi-Fi, Bluetooth and NFC. 

PC COMPONENTS

NVIDIA RTX 30 FOR LAPTOPS AND RTX 3060

NVIDIA announced Ampere architecture based RTX 30 mobile GPUs for laptops built for gaming and content creation. These new GPUs will succeed the older gen RTX 20 series mobile GPUs. NVIDIA partners are reportedly preparing more than 70 models for launch in the coming months. The launch is centered around three RTX SKUs – RTX 3060, RTX 3070 and RTX 3080. NVIDIA stated that these partner laptops featuring the new Ampere GPUs will begin January 26th onwards even though desktop RTX 30 cards are extremely hard to come by in the Indian as well as global markets.

“After taking the desktop market by storm, our NVIDIA Ampere architecture is now powering the world’s fastest laptops,” said Kaustubh Sanghani, vice president and general



manager of GeForce OEM at NVIDIA. “Nowhere does power efficiency matter more than in gaming laptops, a market that’s grown 7x in the past seven years. These new thin and light systems are based on our Max-Q technologies, where every aspect — CPU, GPU, software, PCB design, power delivery, thermals — is optimized for power and performance.”

More Mobile Gaming

NVIDIA has had Max-Q and Max-P GPUs for gaming and content creation use cases. Max-Q variants are slightly underclocked compared to their desktop variants whereas Max-P are closer to their desktop cousins. Thus far, the desktop RTX 3060 has proven to provide a significant performance increment over the desktop RTX 2080 and even equalling the RTX 2080 Super in some games. It remains to be seen if the same characteristics will be observed in these new notebook GPUs as well.

The RTX 3070 also boasts of a significant performance uptick over the RTX 2070 and is suited for 1440p gaming. And lastly, the RTX 3080 features a massive 16GB video buffer and claims to provide more than 100 FPS with ultra settings at 1440p. When it comes to eSports, these new RTX 30 laptops claim to provide more than 240 FPS ensuring